

GUIDELINES FOR THE PREPARATION OF REPORTS BY MEMBER STATES ON THE APPLICATION OF THE 1960 CONVENTION AND RECOMMENDATION AGAINST DISCRIMINATION IN EDUCATION

Approved by the UNESCO Executive Board at its 207th session in October 2019

1. Introduction

The Convention against Discrimination in Education (“the Convention”) and the Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (“the Recommendation”), adopted by UNESCO’s General Conference in 1960, respond to UNESCO’s constitutional mandate to “*advance the ideal of equality of educational opportunities without regard to race, sex or any distinctions, economic or social*”. The Convention is the first legally binding international instrument providing for the **right to education** and the only one exclusively devoted to it.

The right to education is today one of the key principles underpinning the Education 2030 agenda and Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG4) adopted by the international community. SDG4 is rights-based and seeks to ensure the full enjoyment of the right to education as fundamental to achieving sustainable development. Its scope captures the multidimensional nature of the right to education.

The Convention has been recognized as a **cornerstone of Education 2030 agenda**. It also represents a powerful tool to advance SDG4 by ensuring effective articulation between normative and operational work.

The present Guidelines are intended to assist Member States in the preparation of national reports on the implementation of the Convention as well as the Recommendation in the context of the 10th Consultation.

2. Reporting obligations

There are differences in the legal nature of the obligations under the Convention, as distinguished from those under the Recommendation. The Convention has binding force and the States Parties are obliged to incorporate its provisions into their national Constitution or domestic law. The Recommendation, non-binding in nature, has political and moral force. Its adoption sought to take into account the difficulties that certain states might experience, in particular on account of their federal structure, in ratifying the Convention.

Bearing in mind the differences in wording and in legal scope inherent to the nature of these two categories of instruments, the content of the Recommendation is identical to that of the Convention. Member States are expected to give effect to it in national legislation and education policies.

Most importantly, the reporting obligation under the provisions of Article VII of the Convention and of the Recommendation is the same. Article VIII of UNESCO’s Constitution states that “*Each Member State shall submit to the Organization, at such times and in such manner as shall be determined by the General Conference, reports on the laws, regulations and statistics relating to its educational, scientific and cultural institutions and activities, and on the action taken upon the recommendations and conventions referred to in Article IV, paragraph 4*”. Therefore, even if a country is not a State Party to the Convention, it needs to submit a report on the implementation of the Recommendation, which means that **all UNESCO Member States are expected to submit a national report** on the implementation of these instruments in the context of monitoring consultations.

3. Participation in consultations

In light of the Education 2030 agenda, the monitoring of the implementation of the Convention and the Recommendation is of crucial importance in order to ensure an education that is truly for all and to counter persistent inequalities in access, participation and learning outcomes at all levels, particularly for the most vulnerable groups. Concrete measures taken by Member States in accordance with their legal obligations under these instruments contribute to this process.

As the scope and content of the legal obligations under the right to education are aligned with the 10 targets of SDG4 on education, efforts have also been made to ensure that the specific components are included in the guidelines and that the guidelines serve as a valuable monitoring tool for measuring progress towards SDG4 targets.¹ In addition, in view of the educational challenges posed by the influxes of refugees and displacements worldwide, the guidelines provide the opportunity to report on concrete measures taken during the reporting period to include refugees and migrants in their educational systems. An emphasis is also to be placed on legal and policy framework that protects the rights of national minorities.

The reporting should be as comprehensive as possible and the process needs to be **participatory** and conducted in cooperation between ministries of education and other ministries dealing with aspects of the right to education. Relevant information from CSOs having education as their main field of activity should also be provided.

The preparation of national reports provides a **good opportunity** for Member States to assess the implementation of the right to education in their country, identify specific challenges, build constructive dialogue with other actors involved in this field and share good practices.

4. General indications

The reporting period for the 10th Consultation on the implementation of the Convention and the Recommendation covers four years (2017-2020).

Member States that already reported to the 9th Consultation (2016-2017) are invited to **refer to their reports** when appropriate. Relevant information supplied for other reporting instances may be reproduced or referred to with precise indication as to its retrieval. Similarly, hyperlinks to any useful documents or relevant legal and policy texts are most welcome and texts can also be added in the annex.

In the preparation of reports, Member States are kindly requested to provide brief and concise information, although they may provide details on the scope of the question if deemed necessary. In addition to a description of the constitutional, legislative, administrative and policy framework established for the implementation of the provisions guaranteed by the instruments, the information supplied by Member States should demonstrate how legal norms and practices comply with the Convention and the Recommendation.

5. Modalities

With a view to simplify the Guidelines while providing necessary substantive information to assist Member States in the preparation of responses, two series of questions/remarks are presented:

- (1) Open-ended and closed-ended questions to be directly filled in by Member States through a participatory process. Please note that multiple answers may be provided where relevant.

¹ Please note that the 1974 Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms is used specifically for monitoring SDG target 4.7. The 1960 Convention and Recommendation contribute more generally to the body of evidence for monitoring the targets of SDG4.

- (2) Additional information aimed at guiding Members States to structure and detail their responses to the open-ended questions (including remarks on how to respond efficiently to the questions raised). These elements are presented in italics.

In their responses, Member States are encouraged to provide information in a concise manner while preserving substantive and relevant content.

GENERAL INFORMATION:

Country name: [Egypt](#)

Organization or entity responsible for the preparation of the report:

[Egyptian National Commission for UNESCO](#)

[Ministry of Higher Education and scientific research \(supreme council of universities \)](#)

[Ministry of Education and vocational Education \(National Center for Educational research and Development](#)

I. Information on the legislative, judicial, administrative and other measures taken by the state at the national level

1. Ratification of the Convention²

Is your country a State Party to the Convention?

☒ [Yes](#)

☐ No: Does your country plan to ratify this instrument?

☐ Yes: Please indicate the stage of ratification process reached by your country:

☐ Close to ratification

☐ Underway

☐ Actively under preparation

- Please briefly explain the difficulties encountered in completing the ratification process and the means of overcoming them:

Describe:

➔ *the obstacles, whether legal, institutional, political or practical*

→ the means of overcoming them and the extent to which UNESCO can assist in completing the process

☐ No, not considering ratification in the near future. Please explain why:

2. Ratification of the Protocol³ instituting a Conciliation and Good Offices Commission to be responsible for seeking the settlement of any disputes which may arise between States Parties to the Convention against Discrimination in Education

Has your country ratified the Protocol?

☒ Yes

☐ No, please briefly explain the difficulties encountered:

3. Legal framework governing the protection of rights guaranteed in the Convention and the Recommendation in the national legal system

In case your country is a State Party to the Convention:

- Is the Convention directly applicable in your country's domestic law following its ratification?

☒ Yes ☐ No

- If not, has it been incorporated into the national Constitution or domestic law so as to be directly applicable?

☒ Yes ☐ No

This seeks information on whether the provisions of the Convention are guaranteed in a domestic legal instrument. The report should list the main legal texts (Constitution, legislative text or other provisions) adopted to guarantee the right to education for all and to promote equal educational opportunities. References, dates and aims could be provided.

The text and articles of the convention are guaranteed in the "2014 Constitution, Education Law No. 139 of 1981, Education Law No. 155 of 2007". This will be detailed in the following points of the report

- Have the provisions of the Convention been invoked before and given effect to by courts, tribunals and administrative authorities?

☐ Yes ☒ No

If yes, please illustrate on the basis of available case law and jurisprudence. Information could also be given about the judicial, administrative and other competent authorities having jurisdiction with respect to the rights guaranteed by the Convention and the scope of such competence.

In case your country is not a State Party to the Convention:

- Have legislative measures been taken pursuant to the Recommendation?

☐ Yes ☐ No

If yes, the report could list the main texts adopted to guarantee the right to education for all and to promote equal educational opportunities. References, dates and aims could be provided.

- Please explain briefly the extent to which public policies and programmes correspond to the general provisions of the Recommendation.

Information supplied could demonstrate how such policies and programmes comply with commitments of the right to education under the Recommendation.

II. Information on the implementation of the Convention or Recommendation

1. Non-discrimination and equal opportunities in education in the context of Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG4)

Articles/Paragraphs 1(1), 2 and 3 of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-discrimination and equal opportunities in education. This part relates to the main purpose of the Convention/Recommendation that is to underscore the state obligation to proscribe any form of discrimination in education while promoting equality of educational opportunity.

*This corresponds to the overall aspiration of SDG4 which aims to “**ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all**” by 2030. It therefore covers all the SDG4 targets, but also specifically SDG target 4.5.⁴*

- 1.1 Please indicate measures adopted by your government to eliminate and prevent discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation (please tick all that apply)⁵ (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

⁴ Which calls on states to “eliminate gender disparities in education and ensure equal access to all levels of education and vocational training for the vulnerable, including persons with disabilities, indigenous peoples and children in vulnerable situations”.

- ☒ Constitutional laws and/or legislation prohibit discrimination in education
- ☒ Regulations prohibit discrimination in education
- ☒ Policies and programmes aim to eliminate and prevent discrimination in education
- ☒ Access to justice in case of violations of the right to non-discrimination in education
- ☒ Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum
- ☐ Other:

Please provide a brief description of the relevant legal, regulatory or policy texts including measures on:

- ➔ *Non-discrimination in the admission of pupils to educational institutions*
- ➔ *Non-differential treatment, including of foreign nationals resident in your country*

Non-discrimination in the admission of students to pre-university and educational institutions:

- Every child has the right to early education in a centre for childhood up to the age of six. "Article 80 of the Constitution of the Arab Republic of Egypt ,2014".
- "Education is a right for every citizen," Article 19 of the Constitution of the Arab Republic of Egypt 2014.
- "Pre-university education is a right for all citizens in state/ governmental schools free of charge, students are not be required to pay fees in exchange for educational services provided to them." Article 3 of Education Law No. 199 of 1981.
- "The state shall guarantee the rights of children with special needs, their rehabilitation, and their integration into society" Article 80 of the Constitution of the Arab Republic of Egypt 2014.
- Since the academic year 2019/2020, applying to the kindergarten stage has been made through the website of each governorate to ensure the criteria of transparency and equality between pupils, the results are announced electronically and the admission procedures are completed by the educational administrations.
- Submission and nomination of pupils to join the first grade of primary school has become through the website of the Ministry of Education, which guarantees that there is no discrimination in admission among students in any way.

Non-differential treatment, including of foreign nationals resident in Egypt :

- There is no discrimination in education, and this is stipulated in the 2014 Constitution in Article 9 and Article 53.

- In the tertiary Education
- Regarding the Universities Organization Law 49 of 1972 and its executive regulations and Egyptian Ministerial Resolution No. 2555 of 2020 dated 11/8/2020 concerning the system and rules for admission of students with the Egyptian General Secondary Certificate and its equivalent (from Arab and foreign certificates), technical certificates and the Azhar high school diploma in 2020
- The number of students admitted to public universities from the high school through the University Admissions Coordination Office in 2017/2018 reached 387 thousand students and increased to 426 thousand students in 2018/2019, an increase of (10.7%), and the numbers increased to 453 thousand students in 2019 /2020
- The total number of students admitted from high school holders through the Office for the Coordination of Admission to Governmental Universities was (426090) students which the number was (203050) male students by 47.7%, and the number (223040) female students by 52.3%).
- In the university graduated stage in 2017/2018, the total number of students in universities increased from one million 804 thousand students to 2 million and 151 thousand students in 2018/2019 (an increase of 19.2%)
- In 2018/2019, the total number of students in all public universities colleges reached (2151661) students (of which there are (1074925) male students by 49.96%, and the number (1076736) female students by 50.04%)

Egypt approved United Nations General Assembly Resolution 40/144 of December 13, 1985 regarding the Declaration on the Human Rights of Individuals who are not citizens of the country in which they reside.

1.2 Please indicate actions taken by your government to guarantee equal access to all levels and types of education in your country (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

- ☒ Constitutional laws and/or legislation guarantee equal access to education
- ☒ Regulations ensure equal access to all levels and types of education
- ☒ Policies and programmes ensure equal access to all levels and types of education
- ☐ Other:

- Please indicate the relevant legal, regulatory or policy texts and provide a brief description of the measures taken:

This notably is covered under SDG target 4.1 and partly target 4.b⁶

1.3 Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially

⁶ Which calls on states to “substantially expand globally the number of scholarships available [...] for enrolment in higher education, including vocational training and information and communications technology, technical, engineering and scientific programmes”.

marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☒ Providing financial incentives and fellowships | ☒ Providing auxiliary assistance |
| ☒ Providing positive or affirmative action measures | ☒ Adapting education infrastructure |
| ☒ Ensuring inclusion in mainstream schools for all learners | ☒ Adapting curricula and methods |
| ☒ Training teachers on inclusive education | ☐ Providing language classes to newcomers (e.g. refugees) |
| ☒ Ensuring gender parity in science, technology, engineering and mathematics (STEM) and technical and vocational training (TVET) | ☒ Eliminating administrative barriers to education ⁷ |
| ☒ Providing re-entry programmes for young mothers | ☒ Providing flexible learning pathways |
| ☒ Eliminating all barriers for pregnant girls or young mothers in education | ☒ Valuing diversity in schools |
| ☐ Other: | ☐ Combatting stereotyping and stigmatisation |

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken, including those to ensure *gender equality and the empowerment of girls and women in and through education*:

Legislation and laws:

- Equality in education in the Egyptian constitution, As stipulated in the Egyptian Constitution of 2014 Articles 19, 80, 81, and 82.
- Equality in Education in Education Law No. 139 of 1981, As stipulated in Article 3, 15 of the Education Law

Regulations:

- Prime Minister Decision No. 2733 to issue the executive regulations for the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Law.
- School Discipline Bylaw 2019-2020.

Policies and programs:

- Equality in education in the strategic plan for pre-university education 2014-2020.

⁷ Administrative barriers to education include, amongst others, lack of identity papers or birth certificates required to enrol.

Combating discrimination in curricula:

- Article No. 21 of Prime Minister Decision No. 2733 to issue the executive regulations for the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Law.

- Article No. 28 of Prime Minister Decision No. 2733 to issue the executive regulations for the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Law.

- The total number of faculty members is (53409), of whom (30133) members are male, 56.4%, and (23276) female members, representing 43.6%.
- the total number of the assisting body members is (35,637), of whom (21,489) are female, representing 60.3%, and (14,148) male members, representing 39.7%.
- Most Egyptian universities tend to put in place mechanisms and policies to strongly combat such a phenomenon inside universities to protect both women students and employees
- Working committees were formed to combat violence against women and to provide a safe environment inside Egyptian universities

- Please indicate whether your country has adopted and reviewed legislation related to the minimum age for marriage so that it conforms to international standards (18 years):

Please note that child marriage is a discriminatory practice as often girls can marry at a younger age than boys. Child marriage violates the child's right to education as they are more likely to drop out of school and children who are not in school are more likely to get married.

✓ Yes ☐ No ☐

Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions:

Regarding Law No. 126 of 2008 of Civil Status Code, which states that it is not permissible to certify a marriage contract for a person who has not reached the age of eighteen years in full

2. Progress made with respect to implementing the right to education in the context of SDG 4

2.1 Pre-primary education

Pre-primary education is not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the international community has increasingly recognized the importance of early childhood care and education (ECCE) over the years. The Committee on the Rights of the Child initially recognized "the right to education during early childhood as beginning at birth" (General Comment 7). This became more explicit with the 2010 Moscow Framework for

*Action and Cooperation*⁸. In the current context of the Education 2030 agenda, under SDG target 4.2, states have now committed to “the provision of at least one year of free and compulsory pre-primary education”.

- Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available in your country?

✓ Pre-primary education is compulsory: Please provide the age of enrolment and duration:

Pre- primary education is for a duration of 2 years before enrolment in primary at the age of the age of 6 years

✓ Pre-primary education is free of charge for all: Please provide the duration:

Free of charge in public schools for a duration of 2 years

- Please list the laws and policies that ensure the availability of pre-primary education for all and provide information on the difficulties experienced by your government in the realization of access to pre-primary education. Brief quantitative information could be added.

According to Article 8 of Law No. 139 of 1981 regarding the issuance of the Education Law, kindergarten schools are established and are affiliated with public schools and in terms of their specifications, study system and curricula

There are difficulties and challenges facing the development process in the kindergarten stage

There are difficulties and challenges facing the development process in the kindergarten stage, including a deficit in classrooms and the number of teachers

Weak awareness of parents

Lack of nutrition programs in poor areas

Which states that university education is a right for all citizens free of charge and that the duration of the school years is

Nine for basic education

2.2 Universal primary and secondary education

Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for universal primary and secondary education. In the context of the Education 2030 agenda, SDG target 4.1 calls on States to provide “12 years of free, publicly funded, inclusive, equitable, quality primary and secondary education – of which at least nine years are compulsory.”

Primary education

- Is primary education compulsory in your country?

✓ ■ Yes □ No

Please indicate the current duration period of compulsory education and the age of enrolment:

In this part, you may also provide information on the difficulties experienced by your government in the realization of universal access to primary education. Quantitative information could be added.

Tuition fees, tests, school supplies, school uniforms and transportation. Fees are compulsory for the student's father

- Is primary education available free of charge to all?

☒ Yes: Please provide the duration and indicate the extent to which it is.

For this, please list the laws and policies that ensure the universal and free availability of primary education and indicate whether direct and indirect costs are charged (such as tuition fees, exam fees, schools supplies, uniforms, transport costs and compulsory levies on parents).

The period of study for compulsory education is six years for elementary school, three for middle school, and three for high school

✓ ☐ No: Is your country already engaged in legal and policy reforms to work towards universal and free primary education?

✓ ☒ Yes ☐ No

• Please briefly provide information on the reforms taken:

The mentioned stages are mandatory according to Article 19 of the 2014 Constitution of the State, as well as Article 3 of Law 139 of 1981 Which states that pre-university education is a right for all citizens, free of charge, and that the duration of school years is nine for basic education

Secondary education

In this part, please provide information on the general availability and accessibility to all of secondary education, including technical and vocational secondary education and training in your country.

- Is secondary education (middle/high) available free of charge?

✓ ☒ Yes: Please provide the duration and describe the extent to which it is.

Please list the laws and policies that ensure the free availability of secondary education and describe whether direct and indirect costs are covered (such as tuition fees, exam fees, school supplies, uniforms, transport costs and compulsory levies on parents).

The mentioned stages are mandatory according to Article 19 of the 2014 Constitution of the State, as well as Article 3 of Law 139 of 1981 Which states that pre-university education is a right for all citizens, free of charge, and that the duration of school years is

· nine for basic education

- three years for secondary education
- three years for vocational education
- five years for advanced vocational education

☐ No: What are the measures your government intends to take to ensure free secondary education?

The mentioned stages are mandatory according to Article 19 of the 2014 Constitution of the State, as well as Article 3 of Law 139 of 1981

- Is secondary education (middle/high) compulsory in your country?

✓ ☒ Yes ☐ No

- Please provide details on its implementation and indicate the duration of compulsory secondary education and the age of enrolment:

In this part, you may also provide information on the difficulties experienced by your government in the realization of universal access to secondary education. Quantitative information could be added.

- Indicate whether your country has adopted and reviewed legislation related to the minimum age of entry into employment so that it is aligned with the end of compulsory education:

Please note that minimum age labour laws and those related to compulsory education interdependent and mutually reinforce each other. If the minimum age of employment is below that of compulsory education, the child is at risk of dropping out of school to work and therefore not completing compulsory education. On the other hand, if compulsory education is lower than the minimum age of employment, once the child has completed compulsory education, the door is open to child exploitation and the violation of labour laws.

Yes ☒ No ☐

- Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions:

Article 64 of Child Law No. 12 of 1996

Which prevents the child from working before reaching the age of 15 yearsIt is also forbidden to train him before reaching the age of 13years

Article 80 of the state constitution of 2014

Which prevents the child from working before completing basic education

2.3 Higher education

Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3⁹, and target 4.4¹⁰.

- Please indicate the measures adopted to ensure that there is no discrimination on the grounds prohibited by the Convention/Recommendation¹¹ to enter and complete higher education, including technical and vocational education and training (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

- Constitutional laws and/or legislation prohibit discrimination in higher education, including technical and vocational education and training
- Regulations prohibit discrimination in higher education, including technical and vocational education and training
- Policies and programs aim to eliminate and prevent discrimination in higher education, including technical and vocational education and training
- Other:

- Please provide a brief description of the relevant legal, regulatory or policy texts including measures on:

➔ *Non-discrimination in the admission of students to higher education institutions on the grounds prohibited by the Convention/Recommendation*

➔ *Non-differential treatment, including of foreign students*

Enrolment in government universities and institutes takes place through the Coordination Office, the criterion of which is the comparison between students on the basis of total scores at the secondary level.

The Supreme Council of Egyptian Universities in 2019 approved the admission of international students, subject to conditions set by the embassies of countries.

The credit hour programs were launched

Coordination has been made between the Ministry of Higher Education and the Ministries of Foreign Affairs and Interior to facilitate the expatriate students.

The cost of studying in Egypt is low compared to other Arab countries

Also Regarding the Universities Organization Law 49 of 1972 and its executive regulations and Egyptian Ministerial Resolution No. 2555 of 2020 dated 11/8/2020 concerning the system and rules for admission of students with the Egyptian General Secondary Certificate and its equivalent (from Arab and foreign certificates), technical certificates and the Azhar high school diploma in 2020

The number of students admitted to public universities from the high school through the University Admissions Coordination Office in 2017/2018 reached 387 thousand students and

⁹ Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”.

¹⁰ Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”.

¹¹ See: Article/Paragraph 1(1).

increased to 426 thousand students in 2018/2019, an increase of (10.7%), and the numbers increased to 453 thousand students in 2019 /2020

The total number of students admitted from high school holders through the Office for the Coordination of Admission to Governmental Universities was (426090) students which the number was (203050) male students by 47.7%, and the number (223040) female students by 52.3%).

In the university graduated stage in 2017/2018, the total number of students in universities increased from one million 804 thousand students to 2 million and 151 thousand students in 2018/2019 (an increase of 19.2%)

In 2018/2019, the total number of students in all public universities colleges reached (2151661) students (of which there are (1074925) male students by 49.96%, and the number (1076736) female students by 50.04%)

- Please indicate efforts made by your government to ensure that higher education is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make "higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity". Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights, further adds that this should be pursued by "every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education".

Higher education is generally free of charge

- Higher education is accessible on the basis of individual capacity as assessed by reference to relevant qualifications and experience
- Higher education is accessible through financial incentives and scholarships
- Higher education is accessible through positive or affirmative action measures
- Higher education is accessible through credit transfer system between states
- Other:

Only 27 university have free of charge only in Governmental university

As of the academic year 2019/2020, Egypt launched the "Study in Egypt" application to help students wishing to study in Egypt from around the world.

The Ministry of Higher Education partnered with international universities and made twinning work

About 35 local, regional and international cooperation agreements and protocols were signed

The expatriate residence has been developed

Cost is lowered compared to surrounding countries

27 governmental universities that include (495) colleges and institutes, (433) colleges, (23) technical nursing institutes, (39) colleges and institutes for higher studies.

the most important achievements that have been made in the field of university education

are the following:

Firstly, quantitative indicators:

In the academic year 2017/2018 compared to the academic year 2018/2019.

**The number of public universities increased from 24 universities to 27 universities after converting (3) branches of universities (Matrouh - New Valley - Luxor) into independent universities.

**The Council of Ministers decided in its session No. (98), held on 1/7/2020, to approve the establishment of (4) Egyptian private universities, and they are:

- New Mansoura,
- Al-Alamein International,
- King Salman International,
- Al-Galala

Regarding to Law No. 143 of 2019 and Law No. 12 of 2009 and its executive regulations Egyptian private universities are a new generation of smart universities, not for profit, but aiming at global competition in the field of science and technology, developing culture, preserving Egyptian identity and strengthening ties with Arab and African countries by providing higher education that supports innovation and creates a generation capable of leadership regionally and globally, also there is a twining Programs with European universities

22 Egyptian universities have been included in the QS classification

- Please elaborate on the measures taken and provide brief information on the financial costs to receive education in higher public or private education institutions, if higher education is not free of charge.

In this part, you may also provide information on the difficulties experienced by your government as regards access to higher education and on the progress realized. Quantitative information could be added.

The state seeks to have admission according to a capacity test

The transition from secondary education to university requires a standard other than an exam

Regarding the Universities Organization Law 49 of 1972 and its executive regulations and Egyptian Ministerial Resolution No. 2555 of 2020 dated 11/8/2020 concerning the system and rules for admission of students with the Egyptian General Secondary Certificate and its equivalent (from Arab and foreign certificates), technical certificates and the Azhar high school diploma in 2020

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In 2018/2019, the total number of students in all public universities colleges reached (2151661) students (of which there are (1074925) male students by 49.96%, and the number (1076736) female students by 50.04%)

2.4 Adult education and alternative learning

Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.”

- Please indicate the efforts made by your government to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

- Provision of education for persons who have not received or completed the whole period of their primary education
- Provision of literacy programmes
- Provision of appropriate learning and life-skills programmes
- Provision of free of charge learning opportunities
- Provision of flexible learning pathways
- Provision of professional training and qualifications
- Other:

According to the article 18 of the Egyptian constitution, which was issued on September 11 1971 ,

That: "Education is a right guaranteed by the state in the primary stage, and the state shall work to extend this obligation".

independence of universities and scientific research centers;

Also, basic education is a right for all Egyptian children who reach the age of six

Extending the stage of free education to 11 years according to Article (15) of the Constitution of the Republic Arab Egypt,

•

Ensuring the right of every child to early education in a childhood center up to six years of age is prohibited

The state guarantees the rehabilitation and integration of handicapped children into society

Through health, economic and social rights Cultural, entertainment, sports and education, and providing them with job opportunities

Extending the obligatory period to include basic education, according to Article 15 of the Education Law No. 139 of 1981

Extending the free compulsory period to the age of 12, according to Article 19 of 2014

The mentioned stages are mandatory according to Article 19 of the 2014 Constitution of the State, as well as Article 3 of Law 139 of 1981 Which states that pre-university education is a right for all citizens, free of charge, and that the duration of school years is

- nine for basic education
- three years for secondary education
- three years for vocational education

five years for advanced vocational education

Providing a technical education that leads to enrollment in higher technical education

Providing equipment in buildings for people with special needs in accordance with relevant standards And maintain them periodically.

Regarding to Strategy for Pre-University Education which confirmed In Raising community awareness of the advantages of technical education and the employment opportunities

Laying the foundation for the dual system in technical education with the help of the German government; which it reflected in the successful implementation of the Mubarak Cole program 1990 Which is provided through technical secondary schools for the dual education and vocational training

Providing literacy and adult education programs:

The Egyptian government believes in the importance of the issue of literacy and adult education in progress

Egyptian society and overcoming many of its problems; several measures have been taken to combat through Launching the literacy project using technology and digital technology:

Preparing an implementation plan for the project of using in literacy.

-Preparing expressions (artistic - educational) to produce interactive educational materials for learners in literacy classes.

Training for adult education trainers to use technology in adult education.

Training teachers in the field of adult education on the use of digital technology in literacy.

-Using the method of distance education to train teachers in literacy classes on how to use

Digital technology in preparing educational materials for literacy learners.

-Selecting the best distinguished teachers to explain and record literacy curricula using technology

- 2.5 Quality education provision and learning environment

Articles/Paragraphs 2, 4(b) and 5(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for quality education. Quality education is fundamental to achieve all targets of SDG4. It is also particularly highlighted in SDG target 4.a that recommends states to “build and upgrade education facilities that are child, disability and gender sensitive and provide safe, non-violent, inclusive and effective learning environments for all”.

- Please indicate the measures taken by your country to ensure equivalence in all educational institutions with regard to (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

- Establishment of minimum norms and standards in education
- Establishment of conditions relating to the quality of the education provided (e.g. infrastructure, learner/teacher ratios, teaching and learning materials, use of ICT)
- Adoption of legal or regulatory provisions to ensure that children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools).

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:

To provide such quality assessment, please take into account all educational institutions of the same level. You may include information on policies, protocols or codes of conduct.

The Authority for Education and Quality Assurance has adopted standard national standards for evaluation and accreditation

Provide a safe environment free from violence inside and outside the school

Measures for the quality of the educational process:

Interest in the concept of quality education began with the beginning of Basic Education Improvement Program funded From the World Bank and the European Union; And interest in it increased with the beginning of the new millennium

Transforming schools through a number of educational projects and in response to needs the development of education and upgrading its quality

ensure the quality of education and accreditation

Set the necessary policies to ensure the quality of education. Through The Authority's Executive Regulations

taking measures to ensure the accreditation of educational institutions in Egypt in accordance with transparent national standards

Debate at the level of educational directorates and departments »with the aim of qualifying and accrediting schools

The National Authority for Quality Assurance and Accreditation designed and prepared the standards required for evaluation and accreditation Areas of Institutional Capacity »and includes: (the school's vision and mission of leadership and governance; resources

In addition to the above; The National Authority for Quality Assurance and Accreditation has issued documents It includes standards and indicators in all subjects in basic and secondary education; it has also issued guides To accredit educational institutions at all levels of education: (Kindergarten - Basic Education – Education Secondary education, both general and technical - higher education)

The authority plays a major role in laying down the rules and foundations by which the various works

University, pre-university and Al-Azhari educational institutions with regard to distance education, the authority is currently working On developing methodological frameworks for special training programs for distant learning processes, on which he will be trained

Commitment to the right of every child to an equal opportunity to receive educational service at a level of quality commensurate with

Strengthening the institutional structure, especially in technical schools »and building the capacity of education personnel onThe application of decentralization in a way that ensures good governance.

Providing a safe learning environment free from violence inside and outside the teacher .

The Ministry of Education, in cooperation with the National Center for Educational Research and Development, has prepared School Discipline List which includes a group of behavioral offenses It promotes learning and disciplinary strategies that contribute to improving social relationships and interactions

2.6 Education personnel

Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”.

- Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels in your country and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

- ☐ Teachers' average salaries are competitive or at least comparable to those paid in other professions requiring similar or equivalent qualifications (at all levels)
- Initial training and continuous professional development is provided
- Minimum standards and qualifications are required for the teaching profession
- Measures taken to strengthen the social status and attractiveness of the teaching profession
- Performance monitoring systems
- Measures taken to increase women in leadership positions in education
- Other:

- Please briefly elaborate further on the measures taken:

New Teacher Qualification Program:

Intellectual framework

The Ministry of Education took the initiative to establish a special cadre of teachers to support career growth

Obtaining professional development opportunities provided by the system or that depend on the self-initiative,

In order for the teacher to move from one level to the next, he or she must participate in professional development activities through passing specific evaluation procedures.

The first level of the private cadre is the most and It is important to define the criteria that must be met in new teachers in order to move from The first level 'assistant teacher' to the second level 'teacher': as well as identifying development steps

The Ministry of Education has set national standards that clearly define knowledge And the skills and attitudes that must be available to the teacher in order to perform at the acceptable level

These criteria should define the basis for evaluating the performance of the modern teacher, as well as the opportunities for professional development

A teaching assistant must pass a standards-based education program to become a teacher

Whether this modern teacher was newly appointed or redirected from Faculties of Education

General framework of the program:

The program should consist of the following components:

The preparation should provide the assistant teacher with all necessary resources to help

him start his life

The process is positive and should take place at the school level and focus on the duties and responsibilities of the pro-teacher inside the school.

It is provided through the various training units (Training Administration / Training Center).

Provide initial training and continuous professional development

Preparing a new teacher training program

Launching the Teachers First Program to change and improve teaching and learning processes, with the support of the state

Digital teacher training

The 'Teachers First' program relies on four main pillars:

Enhancement through continuous professional development.

enable the best of practice societies.

Participation in the mentorship program.

The Behavior Change Point Monitoring Platform.

- Have there been instances of discrimination as regards the training for education personnel in your country?

☐ Yes: Has your government addressed this issue?

☐ Yes

☒ No

☐ No

2.7 Respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms

Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms. This is covered under SDG target 4.7.¹² Please note that this section contributes to the general monitoring of Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation and that the consultation on the 1974 Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms will be used specifically for monitoring SDG4 indicator 4.7.1.

- Please indicate the national efforts taken in directing education to the full development of the human personality and the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

☒ Curriculum includes human rights education

☒ Educational and/or extracurricular activities are organized on human rights education

¹²

Which calls on states to "ensure that all learners acquire the knowledge and skills needed to promote sustainable development, including, among others, through education for sustainable development and sustainable lifestyles, human rights, gender equality, promotion of a culture of peace and non-violence, global citizenship and appreciation of cultural diversity and of culture's contribution to sustainable development".

☐ Other:

All curricula aim to promote the concept of global citizenship

As well as extra-curricular activities

Under Egypt's education law, education is a Human Right for all , it is an essential tool for achieving the goals of equality, development and peace. Moreover, there were efforts to improve the human personality, promote human rights and fundamental freedoms, provide Egyptian citizens with the appropriate values, studies and components that upgrade his/ her character and affirm human dignity, example of this are as follows:

- **Pre-University Strategic Plan (2014-2030)** emphasizes the interest in developing curricula, which would firms up the Egyptian national affiliation, and enhances the preservation of identity.
- **The National Information and Communication Technology Strategy** emphasizes efforts aiming to transformation of Society to a digital society , a knowledge-based advanced economy and guarantees the digital access rights of all citizens.
- **The Egyptian Organization for Human Rights** was established in 1985 to operate in accordance with the principles of the Universal Declaration Of Human Rights.
- **The Egyptian Center for Women's Rights** was established to enhance and support the Egyptian woman and promote gender equality .
- **The Cairo Center for Human Rights** was established in 1993 with the aim to promote and respect the values and principle of human rights in Egypt.

School curricula and human rights education

It aims to root in students universal concepts such as citizenship and Voluntary work, peace, tolerance and respect for the Other .

Summer activities for human rights education

This suggested activity can help the teacher learn and transfer to students life skills related to human rights .

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2.8 Private education

Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for private education.

- Does your country have a regulatory framework relating to the establishment and functioning of private educational institutions?

☒ Yes ☐ No

- Please provide a brief description:

According to the Constitution of the Arab Republic of Egypt, education is the right of every citizen, its aim is to build the Egyptian character and preserve the national identity. Private and State/governmental schools are under the supervision of the Ministry of Education.

There are several legal and ministerial decrees issued by the Minister of Education and Education that aim to regulate the work relationship between private schools on one hand and the Ministry of Education on the other hand.

- Do legal provisions prohibiting discrimination on the grounds listed by the Convention/Recommendation¹⁴ explicitly apply to private educational institutions?

☒ Yes ☐ No

- Please briefly describe what laws, regulations or policies guarantee that the development of private education does not generate discrimination and that private schools offer a relevant alternative in your country:

According to the Ministry of Education's decrees, private schools cannot get license under Names giving any connotation to be limited to a particular category of society.

The main objective to establish private schools, is help in different fields of education without the goal financial profit being in the first place.

- Does your country have an education policy framework for minimum educational standards as regards the rights of the parents /legal guardians for providing religious and moral education for their children?

Pre-university religious education in Egypt can be received through the institutes of Al- Azhar, and the student with the Azhari secondary certificate can complete

¹⁴ See: Article/Paragraph 1(1).

University education at Al-Azhar University. There are two types of Azharinstitutes : Public and private.

The strategic plan for pre-university education in Egypt indicated that there is an agreement with The Azhari Institutes sector allowing transfer from public secondary education and vice versa through several criteria that help parents to choose the right type of education for their children.

☒ Yes ☐ No

2.9 Rights of national minorities

Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. National minorities, who often face language barriers, are among the specific groups referred to in the Convention.

- Please indicate the legal, policy and regulatory measures that protect the rights given to national minorities to carry out their own educational activities (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

☒ Constitutionallaws and/or legislation protect the right to education of national minorities

☒ Legislation or regulations guarantee the right of national minorities to study in their mother tongue

Curriculum is adapted to national minority needs

Teachers are trained to adapt to national minority needs

- As regards the educational standards in educational institutions run by minorities, please describe the existing legal and policy framework:

Information could also cover the language facilities, such as the availability of teaching in the mother tongue of the students, use of teaching of languages in education policy, multilingualism, etc.

Egypt is concerned with the establishment of legislative frameworks that guarantee the protection of minorities. The articles of the Egyptian Constitution stipulate that the religious principles of the Egyptian-Christian and Jews are the main source of legislation for regulating their personal affairs , choosing their religious and spiritual leaderships, as well as affirming freedom of belief , practicing religious rituals .

2.10 Rights of refugees and migrants

The rights of refugees and migrants are not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the Convention and Recommendation call on states to eliminate and prevent discrimination in education based notably on national origin.¹⁵ In this context, a number of Member States that participated in the 9th Consultation reported on measures adopted to ensure refugees' and migrants' right to education. Growing

¹⁵ Articles/Paragraphs 1 and 3.

displacement and influx of refugees worldwide and the emergence of major educational challenges in this area, as well as the frameworks recently adopted by the international community,¹⁶ demonstrate the opportunity for states to report on measures adopted to include refugees and migrants in their educational systems.

Besides, this aspect also corresponds to SDG target 4.5, which calls on states to “ensure equal access to all levels of education and vocational training for the vulnerable”, including “children in vulnerable situations”, and covers the majority of SDG4 targets.

- Please briefly describe the existing legal and policy framework that protects the right to quality education for refugees and migrants in your country.

- Please briefly indicate measures adopted by national and local authorities to ensure refugees' and migrants' right to education (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

☒ Inclusion in mainstream education

☒ Provision of language courses

☒ Specific training for educational staff

☒ Initiatives addressing discrimination and promoting cultural diversity and mutual acceptance

☐ Alternative administrative procedure (placement tests, portfolio of evidence, etc.)

☐ Accelerated learning programmes

☐ Non-formal and/or alternative education programmes

☒ Financial support

☐ Other innovative measures:

This area is related with the fourth objective of sustainable development, which emphasizes equal access to all levels of education and training, including children.

Egypt is working to implement the UN General Assembly Declaration on the Human Rights of Individuals who are not Egyptian national natives of the Country (foreigners). It asserts the rights of foreigners who resides on its lands and protects their freedoms .

An agreement has been signed with UNICEF to improve access for quality education in an environment that protects more than 16,000 child.

III. Methods used to draw the attention of the various authorities in the country to the instruments and to remove the obstacles encountered

1. Challenges and obstacles

¹⁶ Namely the 2016 New York Declaration for Refugees and Migrants, the Comprehensive Refugee Response Framework and the two Global Compacts on refugees and for safe, orderly and regular migration.

- 1.1 Please indicate and provide any information on the difficulties encountered in the process of implementing the key provisions of the Convention/Recommendation (including legal and practical obstacles) and on the main issues that need to be addressed for promoting further the right to education in your country (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

☒ Challenges related to equitable access and inclusion in education (such as poverty and socio-economic factors, cultural and traditional attitudes, remoteness, migration and displacement, etc.)

☒ Challenges related to the quality of education (such as shortages of qualified, trained and motivated teaching staff, non-supportive or inadequate teaching and learning as well as school environment, etc.)

☒ Challenges relating to the system and governance (such as budgetary constraints, lack or weakness of monitoring systems – including the lack of reliable data, absence of supportive/inconsistent/obsolete legal and policy environment, lack of involvement of relevant stakeholders and lack of cooperation/coordination at different levels, etc.)

☒ Other:

Challenges and obstacles

The Egyptian education system faces many challenges that weaken its performance and negatively affect the role assigned to it , among these challenges are:

- The absence of standards in the selection of educational leaders.
- Poor communication channels between parents and management School.
- Absence of the training at the school level.
- Increasing the density of classes in some governorates.
- Insufficient interest to educational activities
- The problem of illiteracy and school leaks.

- 1.2 Please provide a brief assessment of the effectiveness of the methods introduced to remove the obstacles encountered:

Overcoming obstacles

Egypt has made great efforts to overcome the above challenges :

A mid-term comprehensive education program (2016-2018) has been developed with the aim of reform and development in different aspects of education , it was based on a number of policies and programs such as :

- Provide equal opportunities for all children to complete education with priority to poor areas,
- Improve the quality and performance of educational services by supporting institutional infrastructures .
- Capacity-building for education personnel .
- Eliminate class density (reducing number of pupils in a class)
- Integration of persons with special needs into public education.
- Improve the quality of school life.

The strategic plan for pre-university education (2014-2030) has also been based on a number of Objectives to meet challenges, among these objectives are :

- The expansion, (Increasing number of) kindergarten classes.
- Putting a development program Primary and preparatory
- Developing a program for the development of secondary and technical education for the preparation of a graduate qualified to master different skills that meet international standards .
- Providing disabled people with high-quality educational opportunities and integrating them with all schools.
- Providing talented people with high-quality education through developing programs to support talented eminent pupils.
- Developing curricula to suit the requirements of the modern time.
- Development in general to catch up global institutions

2. Awareness-raising

UNESCO governing bodies have underlined the need for awareness raising. Given the importance of normative action at the national level, wide dissemination of the Convention must be ensured, with the support of National Commissions for UNESCO.

- Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (several items could be ticked/mentioned)

☐ Translation of the Convention/Recommendation into the national and possibly local languages

☒ Dissemination and advocacy of the core content of the Convention/Recommendation or the core principles of the right to education

☒ Increased public awareness through advocacy material on the Convention/Recommendation or the core principles of the right to education

☒ Activities undertaken or supported by the National Commission to promote non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities and to foster debate on critical issues in relation to the rights enshrined in the instruments

☒ Other:

In 2018, the Ministry of Education worked with UNESCO Regional Office in Cairo by holding workshops on the 4th Objective of sustainable development with the aim to train leaders in five Governorates in Egypt: BaniSuef, Al-Munufiya, , DakahliamGharbia and Al Minya. The aim of these workshops was to train educational leaders in different ministries such as Education, Youth, Culture and officials responsible for planning and activities on designing and implementing a plan to raise awareness of the 4th objective of the Sustainable Development Goals.

In 2019, awareness raising plans were developed and followed up their implementation at schools and educational departments.